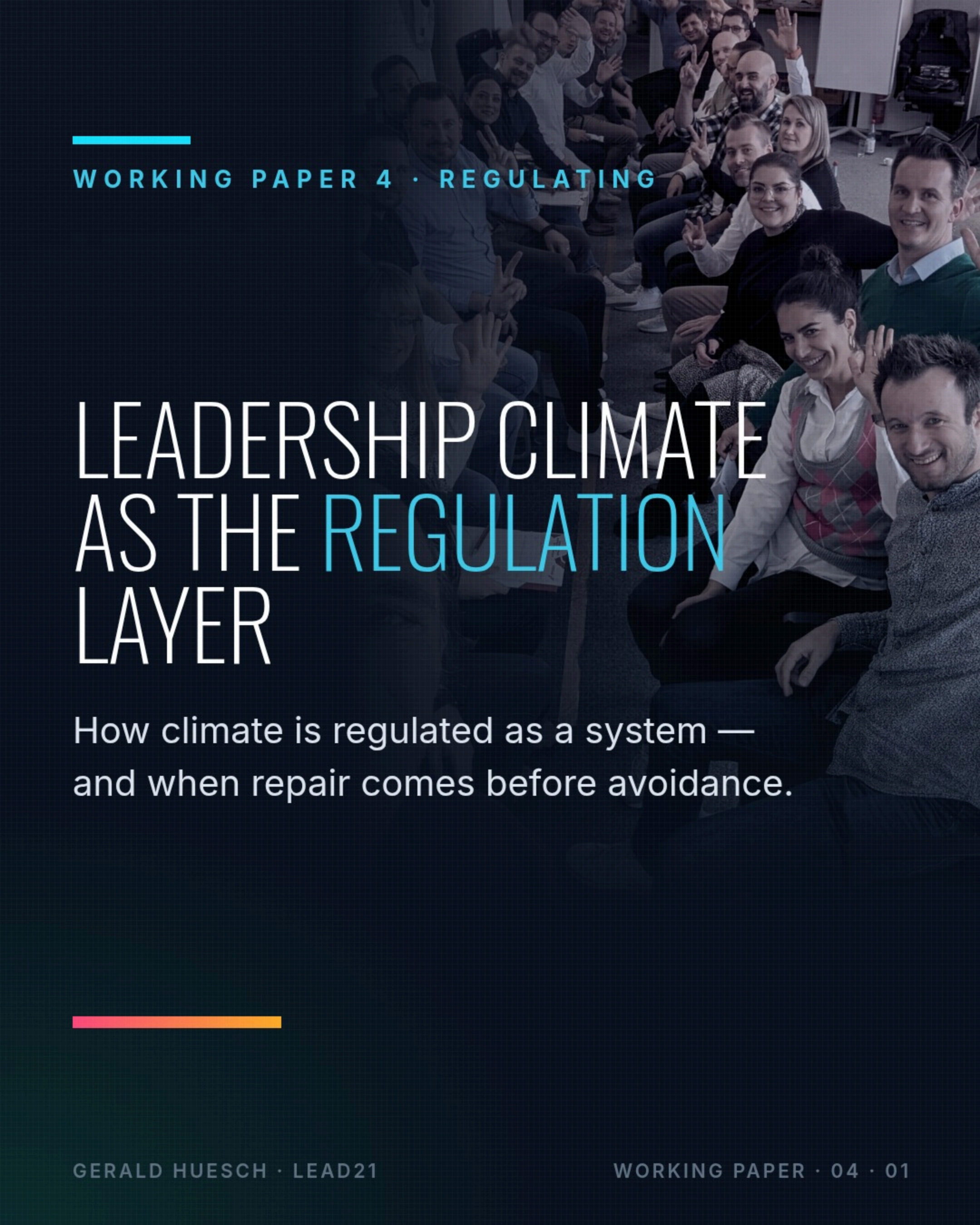


A group of diverse people, including men and women of various ages and ethnicities, are sitting in a room. Many of them are making peace signs with their hands. The background is slightly blurred, showing what appears to be a meeting or workshop setting with a whiteboard and some equipment.

WORKING PAPER 4 · REGULATING

LEADERSHIP CLIMATE AS THE REGULATION LAYER

How climate is regulated as a system —
and when repair comes before avoidance.

BANDS. NOT MAXIMA.

"Needs are regulated toward target bands, like body temperature — balance, never maximization."

Mikeda and Goertzel build a motivational architecture in which seven needs are regulated within **target bands**, not maximized. Each has a band: too little is a problem, too much is one as well.

And the order is the reverse of what one assumes: their cycle **sets the posture before** the situation is reasoned about. Only then does interpretation follow.

Mikeda, A. & Goertzel, B. (2026): A motivational architecture for conversational AGI. AGI 2026, Part II, LNCS 16855, pp. 62–77. Springer.

NO RUPTURE, NO REPAIR.



"No rupture, so no repair; and no stable self. A mirror that never fails gives nothing to push against."

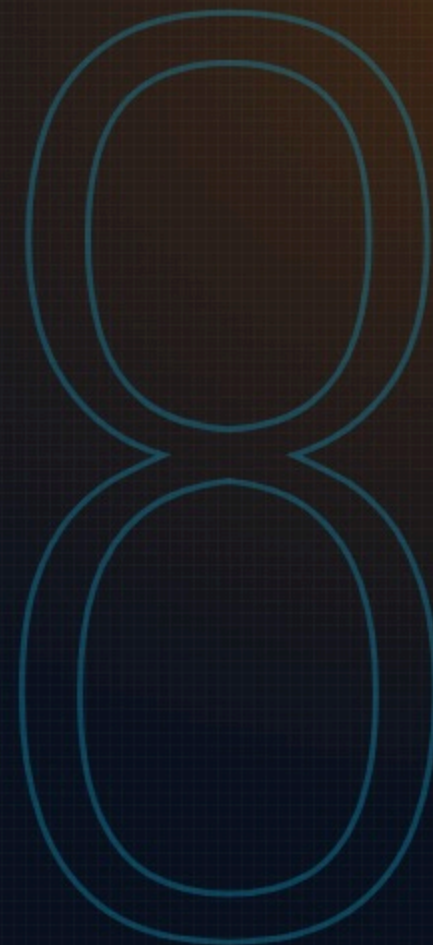
Sabine reaches a finding that is uncomfortable for leadership. Winnicott's mother is good enough **because she fails** — at a rate the infant can use.

His fifth principle: safety is not the goal. It makes exploration affordable.

Translated: a leader who is never wrong gives the team nothing to form itself against. **Reparability is learnable and measurable. Faultlessness is neither.**

Sabine, A. (2026): Phase-gating across precision channels — Topological constraints on multi-channel belief update dynamics. AGI 2026, Part II, LNCS 16855, pp. 219–236. Springer.

EIGHT OF NINE. MEASURED.



A European industrial group, one year, **567 professionals and leaders**, response rate 78 per cent. Three management levels trained — evaluated by four organizational levels. The effect was not surveyed only where the training happened.

Result: significant improvement in **8 of 9** dimensions of the transformation and performance climate. One dimension did not improve — unnecessary rules and administration.

We report what is.

One-year study in a European industrial group, 567 professionals and leaders, response rate 78 %. Scientifically accompanied, independently led by Prof. Dr. Beate Hanson and Prof. Dr. Mohit Bhandari, McMaster University. The only independently measured survey in this series.

NO GOAL CAN BEAR ITS OWN MAXIMUM.

A temperature knows no "more is better". Too low is a problem, too high is one as well. That is exactly what separates a **band** from a scale.

Maximum safety is paralysis. Maximum satisfaction is an inability to take criticism. Maximum urgency is chronic stress.

And care without a band tips over: **"No pathological caretaker maximizing nurturing forever."**

THE MOOD RISES. SO DOES THE LATENCY.

After two years of culture work, a company reaches a very good satisfaction score. At the same time, the number of initiatives abandoned after running too long rises.

In a maximally satisfied environment, criticism is expensive: **it disturbs a good everyone is protecting.**

Then there is timing: the same message reaches a leader differently on Monday morning than on Friday evening — not out of unprofessionalism, but because **posture precedes interpretation.**

EACH AS A QUESTION.

- | | |
|----|--|
| 01 | Competence — am I being effective? |
| 02 | Uncertainty — is the ambiguity manageable? |
| 03 | Affiliation — is the bond intact? |
| 04 | Affinity — quality of being-with |
| 05 | Legitimacy — am I within ethical bounds? |
| 06 | Nurturing — does this person need care? |
| 07 | Aesthetic coherence — is the exchange elegant? |

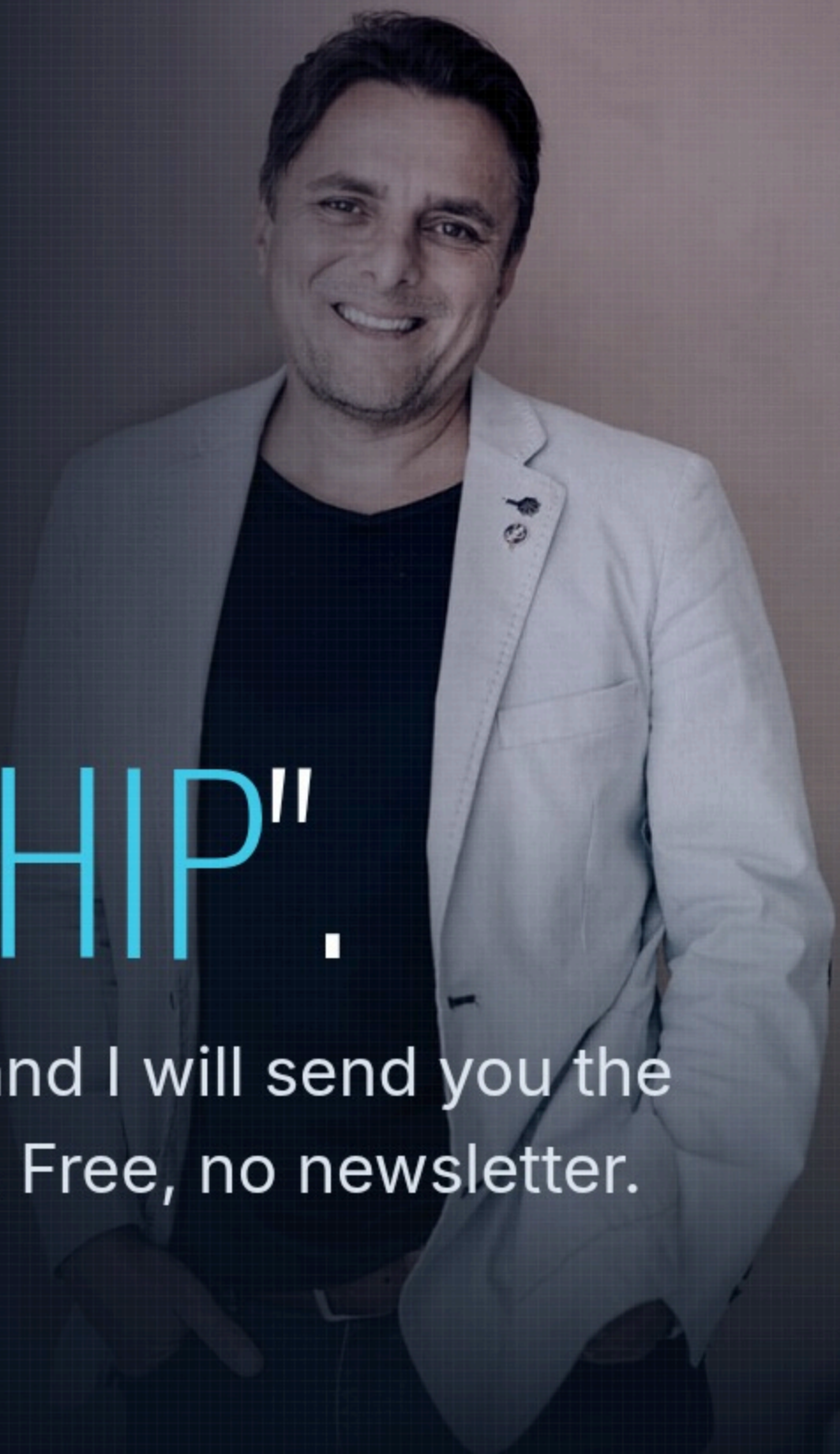
Each need has a target band: too little is a problem, too much is one as well. Source: Mikeda & Goertzel (2026), A motivational architecture for conversational AGI. AGI 2026, Part II, LNCS 16855, pp. 62–77. Springer.

NOT A MOOD READING. A CONTROL LOOP.

Leadership climate is the control loop that determines **which behavior repeats**. Needs belong in target bands, not at maxima. And the effect of a response depends on its timing, not its magnitude.

Leadership Climate surveys regularly across defined dimensions, reflects back to all levels and trains several levels at once. This is exactly where the only measured evidence lies.

Three places do not hold: target bands are not defined, legitimacy and ambiguity are missing as dimensions, and reparability relates to decisions — not to relationships.



NEXT

SEND ME "LEADERSHIP".

as a direct message — and I will send you the working paper as a PDF. Free, no newsletter.

DO THIS TOMORROW

Ask: is our satisfaction within the band – people stay, and dissent stays affordable?

Gerald Huesch — developer of LEAD21, the Leadership OS. Has trained over 30,000 leaders in 30+ countries, including NASA and Rolls-Royce.

All eight papers: gerald-huesch.com/press-en